

4.6.2 PC Inspector File Recovery

(www.pcinspector.de/file_recovery/UK/welcome.htm)

This tool can recover data in three situations—when the data is deleted, when the file index (for the FAT and NTFS filesystems) is corrupted, and when a partition is lost. It is not advisable to use PCIFR in a case where the partition itself is improperly detected. For that, one should use Test Disk first.



Finding lost disks/data with PCIFR

PCIFR first scans the attached drives and lists the partitions on it. If there are partitions detected, a further scan will detect the files that can be recovered. This procedure takes time; how long depends upon the size of the partition. Once the scan is complete, the files are presented. A recently-defragmented disk offers a greater chance of correct recovery of files. Right-clicking on the folder will open the option to save the recovered data. One should always save to a location different from the corrupt drive.

4.7 Partition Tools

Before a hard disk can be used to store data, it is advisable to partition it. The drives that ones sees in the explorer pane are the result of partitioning. Windows offers a GUI-based tool to manage partitions, which shields the user from a lot of complexity, and in most cases a user is better off sticking to it. But for the adventurous kind, who have more than one OS on their system, the application that follows offers greater control over the partitioning process.